

Describing People: Basic Adjectives and Colors

English Lab • Course Guide Session 9



Recap: This/That/These/Those and Everyday Objects: “Whose...?”

- **This / These** describe near objects: *This is a pen* (singular), *These are pens* (plural).
- **That / Those** point to distant objects: *That is a laptop*, *Those are keys*.
- **Whose...?** asks about owner identity: *Whose bag is this?* – *It is mine / hers / theirs*.

Can you point to two items around you and name them with *this* and *that*?

Demonstratives Check

Look at the situation: You are holding two notebooks in your hands. Which sentence is correct?

1. Those is my notebooks.

2. These are my notebooks.

3. This are my notebooks.

4. That are my notebooks.

Demonstratives Check



Look at the situation: You are holding two notebooks in your hands. Which sentence is correct?

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An illustration of four people with different emotions. On the left, a woman with dark hair and a pink sweater is smiling broadly. Next to her, a man with glasses and a beard is looking thoughtful, with his hand on his chin. In the center, a woman with dark hair in a bun and a striped shirt has a surprised expression with her mouth open. On the right, a man with brown hair and a beard is looking tired, with his head resting on his hand. The background features stylized elements: a green leafy branch on the left, a large yellow circle, and a large red circle on the right.

Warm-Up: How Are You Today?

Mime or observe an emotion: **happy**, **tired**, **excited**, or **calm**.

Guess your partner's feeling in English: *"You are tired!"* or *"You are happy!"*

Learning Objectives

1

Objectives: Describe a person's appearance and personality using *be + adjective* (e.g., *He is tall. She is friendly.*).

2

Objectives: Identify and name common colors to describe everyday clothing and objects accurately.

3

Objectives: Ask and answer basic Yes/No questions about appearance and clothing (e.g., *Is he quiet? Is her jacket red?*).

Key Vocabulary



Tall – High stature or height (*alto/a*).



Friendly – Kind, pleasant, and warm (*amigable*).



Red – The bright primary color of ruby or apples (*rojo*).



Blue – The calm primary color of ocean water and clear skies (*azul*).

Physical Appearance: Contrasting Pairs

APPEARANCE

Height and Age

We describe people by pairing the verb *to be* with an adjective. Notice the exact opposite pairs:

- **Tall vs. Short:** *He is tall. His brother is short.*
- **Young vs. Old:** *Sofia is young. Her grandfather is old.*

In Spanish: *alto / bajo, joven / viejo.*



Personality: Character Adjectives

PERSONALITY

Personality words describe how someone acts or treats other people:

- **Friendly / Nice:** *Carolina is friendly. She smiles often.*
- **Funny:** *Alex is funny. He makes everyone laugh.*
- **Quiet / Serious:** *Daniel is quiet and serious in meetings.*
- **Shy / Kind:** *Luisa is shy, but she is very kind.*



Vocabulary Tip

Kind = *amable*; **Funny** = *chistoso / gracioso*.

Grammar Rules: Adjectives

Key structure: No gender or number agreement in English!



Rule 1: Adjectives NEVER change for plurals or gender

Unlike Spanish, English adjectives have only one invariable form:

He is tall. | She is tall. | They are tall. (Never “talls”!)

Rule 2: Adjective before noun OR after Verb TO BE

Position A (After TO BE): *Carlos is friendly.*



Common Spanish Speaker Mistake

Do not say “*They are talls*” or “*She is a woman tall*”.

Match the Opposites

Match the words with the definitions

Quiet

Short

Young

Loud or talkative

Tall

Old

Friendly

Unfriendly

Match the Opposites

Match the words with the definitions



Quiet

A

Short

Young

B

Loud or talkative

Tall

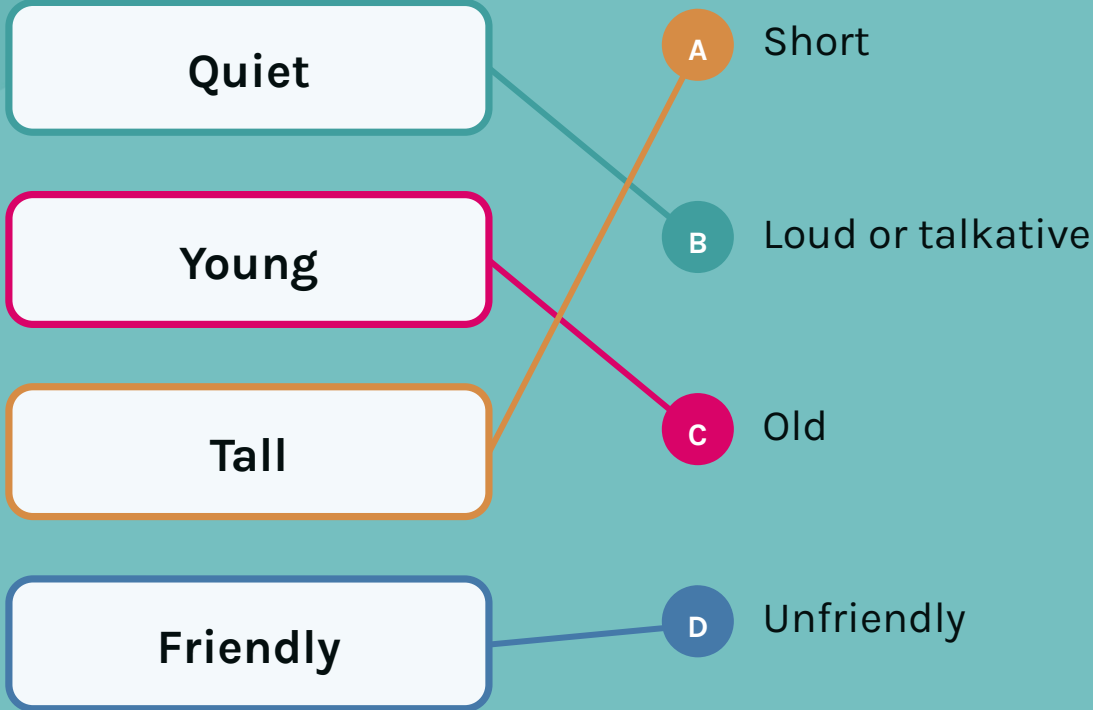
C

Old

Friendly

D

Unfriendly





Colors: Describing Objects and Clothes

Colors function exactly like other adjectives in English. Use them to identify items:

Primary & Everyday Palette: *red, blue, green, yellow, black, white, brown, pink, orange, purple, gray.*

Example: *“What color is her shirt? – Her shirt is blue.” or “She wears a blue shirt.”*



Red Jacket

His jacket is red.

He is wearing a red jacket.



Blue Backpack

The backpack is blue.

It is my blue backpack.



Green Sweater

Her sweater is green.

She is wearing green.



Yellow Umbrella

That umbrella is yellow.

It is her umbrella.

Complete with Colors

Look at Mario. His shoes are _____ and his jacket is _____.

Word bank 

friendly

tall

blue

black

Complete with Colors



Look at Mario. His shoes are **black** and his jacket is **blue**.

Word bank 

friendly

tall

blue

black

Video Lesson: Describing Appearance & Clothes

Watch the video. Listen carefully to how native speakers describe height, hair, clothing colors, and personality traits.



Asking Questions: “Is he...?” / “Is she...?”

Forming Yes/No Questions

To ask about a person, invert the Subject and Verb *TO BE*:

- **Statement:** *He is tall.* → **Question:** *Is he tall?*
- **Statement:** *She is friendly.* → **Question:** *Is she friendly?*

Short Answers:

Yes, he is. / No, he isn't (he's not).

Yes, she is. / No, she isn't (she's not).



Asking About Colors: “What color is...?”



Singular: “What color is...?”

Q: *What color is her shirt?*

A: *It is yellow. / Her shirt is yellow.*



Plural: “What color are...?”

Q: *What color are his shoes?*

A: *They are white. / His shoes are white.*

Listening: Who Is Camilo?

Listen to the audio and answer the questions



Describing a New Coworker

Play audio

- 1 Who is Camilo?
- 2 What is Camilo like physically?
- 3 What color is Camilo's jacket?
- 4 How does Mateo describe Camilo's personality?

Listening: Who Is Camilo?

Check your answers below



Describing a New Coworker

 **Play audio**

1

The new coworker

2

He is very tall

3

Blue

4

Funny and very kind

Connecting Possessives with Descriptions

In Sessions 5 and 6, we learned *his* and *her*. Now we combine them with adjectives and colors:

Step 2: Appearance

He is tall and young. He
is not old.

Step 1: Identify

This is her brother. His
name is Carlos.

Step 3: Details

His shirt is red and he is
very friendly.

How to Describe a Person: 3-Step Formula



1. Physical

Start with height or age:

He is tall. She is young.

2. Personality

Add how they act:

He is friendly and funny.

3. Clothes & Colors

Describe visible items:

His jacket is blue.

Communicative Game: “Who Is It?”

How to play with your partner:

- **Step 1:** Secretly choose one character on the screen.
- **Step 2:** Describe them without saying their name (*“She is tall. Her sweater is green.”*).
- **Step 3:** Partner asks Yes/No questions: *“Is she friendly? Is her bag brown?”*



Who Is It? Guessing Game



Partner A gives three clues using height, personality, and clothing color. Partner B asks two Yes/No questions and guesses the person. What are your clues?

Who Is It? Guessing Game



You might have said...

Clue 1: He is tall.

Clue 2: His shirt is red.

Clue 3: He is funny.

Question: Is he Carlos?

Writing Workshop: Describe a Family Member

Open your family tree notes from Session 5. Select **one family member** (e.g., father, sister, grandfather) and write three short, complete sentences:

Model Student Text:

1. This is my sister. Her name is Laura.

2. She is young, tall, and very friendly.

3. Her favorite jacket is blue.

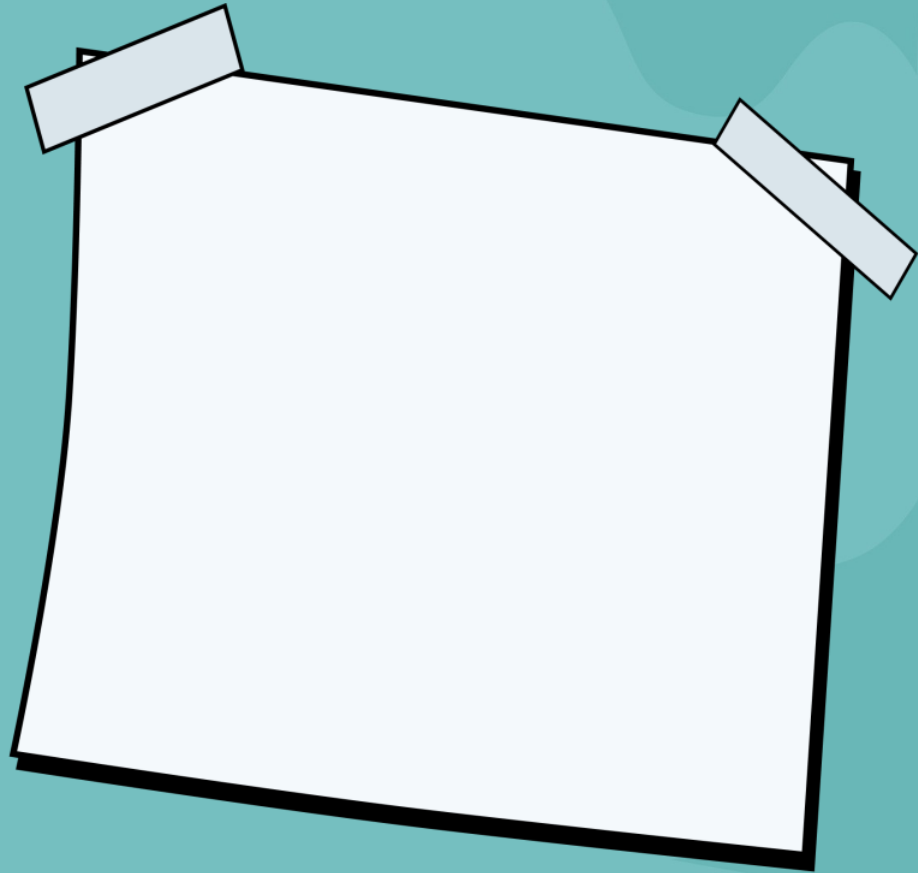
Check: Did you use *He / She is*? Are your adjectives without plural 's'?

Write Your 3 Sentences

Write 3 complete sentences describing one family member from your family tree. Include their relationship, two adjectives for appearance or personality, and one clothing color.

What you'll need: 🎨🖋️

Your family tree notes from Session 5, pen, paper or chat window



Self-Assessment: “I Can...” Progress

Review your progress today toward our Session 12 oral project:



I can describe height and age (*tall, short, young, old*).



I can describe personality (*friendly, funny, quiet, kind*).



I can name clothing colors (*red, blue, green, yellow*).



I can ask and answer: “*Is he tall?*” – “*Yes, he is.*”



Check Your Understanding



Question 1:

How do you describe two tall women in English?

Question 2:

What question asks about the color of someone's shirt?

Question 3:

How do you answer 'Is she friendly?' affirmatively?

Check Your Understanding



Answer 1:

They are tall.

Answer 2:

What color is his / her shirt?

Answer 3:

Yes, she is.